



Dr. Ivy Turk They/She

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Postdoctoral researcher at Ruhr-Universität Bochum.
PhD Computer Science from the University of Cambridge.
Researcher of technology and domestic abuse with a focus on
privacy-enhancing technologies and misuse prevention.

EDUCATION

Wolfson College, University of Cambridge

PhD Computer Science	Technology and Domestic Abuse	Oct 2021 Mar 2026
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Gonville & Caius College, University of Cambridge

MEng (Hons) Computer Science	Honours Pass with Distinction	Oct 2020 Jul 2021
B.A. (Hons) Computer Science	First Class with Honours	Oct 2017 Jul 2020

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research explores the evolving issue of technology being used to facilitate interpersonal harms. I focus on three branches of research:

- Enabling and evaluating support-seeking and evidence gathering through specialised tools
- Evaluating “abusability” and abuse interventions for modern technologies
- Enabling preventative design of systems through changes to established methods

I am an interdisciplinary researcher exploring computer science and criminology through an intersection of security and usability.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

K.I. Turk, A. Hutchings, “Spy-oT: Understanding How Users Discover Malicious Uses of Internet of Things Devices in Domestic Abuse Scenarios”, In Proceedings of the *Twenty First Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS 2025)*, 2025, Seattle, WA, USA.

K. Beadle, **K.I. Turk**, A. Eusebi, M. Tran, M. Ordekian, E. Mariconti, Y. Zhou, M. Vasek, “SoK: A Privacy Framework for Security Research Using Social Media Data”, in *2025 IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (SP)*, San Francisco, CA, USA, 2025, pp. 1178-1196.

K.I. Turk, A. Talas, A. Hutchings, “Threat Me Right: A Human HARMS Threat Model for Technical Systems”, in *Proc. Security Protocols Workshop 2025*, Springer LNCS.

K.I. Turk and A. Hutchings, “Stop Following Me! Evaluating the Effectiveness of Anti-Stalking Features of Personal Item Tracking Devices”, In Proceedings of the *2024 European Symposium on Usable Security (EuroUSEC '24)*, Sept 30-Oct 1, 2024, Karlstad, Sweden.

C. Geeng, N. Chen, **K.I. Turk**, J. Hutson, D. McCoy, ““Say I’m in public...I don’t want my nudes to pop up.” User Threat Models for Using Vault Applications”, In Proceedings of the *Twentieth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS 2024)*, August 11–13, 2024, Philadelphia, PA, USA.

K.I. Turk and A. Hutchings. 2023. “Click Here to Exit: An Evaluation of Quick Exit Buttons”. In Proceedings of the *2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '23)*, April 23–28, 2023, Hamburg, Germany. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 15 pages.

K.I. Turk, A. Hutchings, and A. Beresford, “Can’t Keep Them Away: The failures of anti-stalking protocols in personal item tracking devices”, in *Proc. Security Protocols Workshop 2023*, Springer LNCS.

K. Turk, S. Pastrana, and B. Collier, “A tight scrape: methodological approaches to collecting research data on cybercrime communities in adversarial environments”, in *2020 IEEE European Symposium on Security and Privacy Workshops (EuroS&PW)*, pp. 428–437, 2020.

ADDITIONAL PUBLICATIONS

A. Neumann, J. Wyss, **I. Turk**, R. Overdorf, “It is not enough to give your moderation rules to ChatGPT: Policy-as-Prompt Moderation and Its Potential Impacts on Community Governance”, Mensch und Computer (MuC) 2026 Workshop “Human-Centered Content Moderation: Expertise, Context & Evaluation”, 2026.

J. Wyss, **I. Turk**, A. Neumann, R. Overdorf, “Traces of Abuse: How Generative AI Impacts Image-Based Sexual Abuse (IBSA) Investigations”, Community Building for Researchers on Generative AI-Facilitated Image-Based Abuse (CARA ’26), 2026.

K.I. Turk, A. Talas, “Prevention of Interpersonal HARMS Through Threat Modelling”, Socio-technical Imaginaries for Responsible Design (CHI SIRD), 2026.

V. Khandkar, **K.I. Turk**, E. Toreini, N. Sastry, “SecureWhispers: Creating shared secrets to support domestic abuse victims without exchanging network data”, arXiv preprint. ArXiv:2508.12870 (2025).

P. Doerfler, **K.I. Turk**, C. Geeng, D. McCoy, J. Ackerman, M. Dragiewicz, “Privacy or Transparency? Negotiated Smartphone Access as a Signifier of Trust in Romantic Relationships.”, arXiv preprint. ArXiv:2407.04906 (2024).

ONGOING RESEARCH

I. Turk, J. Wyss, R. Overdorf, “Stop Abandoning Me: Exploring the Landscape of Unmaintained Intimate Partner Abuse Support Applications”. Poster at SOUPS 2026; extended abstract on arXiv; full paper under submission.

I. Turk, A. Neumann, J. Wyss, R. Overdorf, “Distinguishing location sharing use from abuse”.

K. McGregor, **I. Turk**, A. Wehren, “Interventions for LGBTQ+ Technology-Facilitated Abuse: A Scoping Review”.

INVITED TALKS

K.I. Turk, “Usability, Abusability, and Safety by Design: Tools for Pre-emptive Prevention of Interpersonal Harms Through Digital Systems.” Presented at Paderborn University, Leibniz Universität Hannover, and the University of Erlangen-Nuremberg, January 2026.

K.I. Turk, ““The Only Gay in the Village”: The Experiences of LGBTQ+ Technology-Facilitated Abuse Victims.” Presented at the 2nd Gender, Online Safety, and Sexuality Workshop (GOSS) 2025, and the 3rd Cybersecurity and Privacy for Minority and Minoritized People day (CyberMi2) 2025.

L. Hayman, K. Jackson, C. Davidson, L. Parton, **K.I. Turk**, Panel at *European Conference on Domestic Violence (ECDV)*, September 3-5, 2025, Barcelona, Spain.

K.I. Turk, “Technical Tactics Targeting Tech-Abuse: Tales of AirTag and IoT Misuse.” Presented at the University of Edinburgh Controversies in the Data Society, February 14, 2025.

K.I. Turk, “Developing Technical Interventions for Technical Abuse.” Presented at the University of Cambridge, October 29, 2024.

T. Shulruff, L.M. Tanczer, **K.I. Turk**, “Technology-Facilitated Domestic Abuse: Advancements in Its Definition, Scholarship and Response.” Panel at *European Conference on Domestic Violence (ECDV)*, September 11-13, 2023, Reykjavik, Iceland.

K.I. Turk, “The failures of anti-stalking protocols in personal item tracking devices.” Presented at the *IEEE Workshop on Security for Harassment Online, Protections, and Empowerment (SecHOPE)*, 2023.

PROGRAM COMMITTEES AND REVIEWS

Program committee member for TAKEDOWN 2026 (CCS workshop).

Tadpole reviewer for PETS 2026; Reviewer for two papers.

Program committee member for ACM CCS 2025; Reviewer for seven papers.

Program committee member for EuroUSEC 2025; Reviewer for two papers.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Supervisions	University of Cambridge	
Cryptography (3 rd year)	45 students	2021–2024
CyberSecurity (2 nd year)	26 students	2022–2024
Economics, Law, Ethics (2 nd year)	49 students	2022–2025
Digital Electronics (1 st year)	37 students	2022–2025

Dissertation Projects

[BSc] Getting Started with GradeScope: A Think-Aloud Study of First-Time Users’ Initial Submission and Grading Experience	2026
[BA] Reverse Engineering Pin Tumbler Lock Keys From Images	2024–2025
[BA] A Secure Chrome Extension for Domestic Abuse Victims	2024–2025
[BA] Designing Features to Prevent the Repurposing of Applications for IPV	2023–2024
[BA] Access Control Mechanisms for an Adversarial Home Environment	2023–2024
[BA] Identifying Misconfiguration Vulnerabilities in Web Services	2022–2023
[BA] Inferring Firewall Policies using Smart Probing	2022–2023
[MPhil] Malware Decompilation and Classification	2022–2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ruhr-Universität Bochum	Bochum, Germany
CASA Jump.Start Postdoctoral Researcher	April 2026 – Present

- Performed mixed-methods study on abandoned and unusable support applications.
- Ran survey study on location sharing preferences and opinions.
- Frequent contributor to projects within the research group.
- Aided in teaching computational methods for open-source intelligence course.

University of Surrey — AP4L Project	Surrey, UK
Research Engineer in Adaptive Online Safety and Privacy Software	June 2024 – Sept 2025

- Developed Secure Whispers, an application for establishing a secure channel for socially constrained communications scenarios using sensor data derived secrets.
- Developed Support Bubbles, an application for anonymously connecting users undergoing life transitions with verified relevant experts.

NYU Tandon School of Engineering

Student Intern

R

New York, USA

May 2023 – July 2023

- Performed a large range of statistical analyses on survey data using R.
- Designed and implemented an interview study exploring user behaviour.

Entrust / nCipher

Security Intern

Go

Cambridge, United Kingdom

July 2021 – Sept 2021

- Worked on an R&D project to be integrated into nCipher hardware security modules.
- Designed and threat modelled the system, working with multiple teams to improve the design.
- Implemented the system in Go, including the core project, interactions with external components, analytics and automated testing, and an external interface for the system.
- Worked with external companies to integrate their systems as components of the project.

Netcraft

Computer Scientist

Javascript, PHP, Perl, SQL

Bath, United Kingdom

June 2020 – Sept 2020

- Full stack software development on Takedown, a largely automated system which aims to detect, disrupt, and defend against many forms of cybercrime.
 - Frontend development using NodeJS and PHP, interacting with a MySQL Database.
 - Backend library development, automation, and testing using Perl.
- Aided in Spanish translations to contact those who can help defeat instances of cybercrime.

Cambridge Cybercrime Center

Software Developer Intern

Python, JavaScript, Bash, SQL

Cambridge, United Kingdom

June 2019 – Aug 2019

- Created scrapers for underground hacker forums as part of the CrimeBB project.
- Created fget, a Firefox implementation of wget, that combats anti-scraping techniques.
- Created a scraper for Discord to aid research on botnet services.

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

Programming in Python3 since 2016 for both personal projects and professional software development. Using PHP, JavaScript, SQL and HTML since 2017 for websites and smart watch applets. Learned Java, C, C++, SML, Prolog and Matlab during my BA and used for academic projects. Learned Go, Bash and Perl during internships for back end development and automation. Learned R during an internship and used for statistics in academic research.

NATURAL LANGUAGES

- Spanish CEFR / DELE B2 certified by the Cambridge University Language Center.
- Russian CEFR A2 achieved through a combination of online courses and self study.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Cambridge University Cyber Security Society Committee Member 2021-2024
 - Presented workshops on Intro to CTFs, Web Hacking, and Physical Security
- Wolfson College Bar Co-Manager for 2024-2025, Staff since Jan 2023
- President (2022-24), Vice-president (2021-22) of Wolfson Pole and Aerial Sports Society
- Webmaster for the LGBTQ+@CL group 2022-2025

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

- Play Acoustic and Electric Guitar, Bass, Banjo, Tenor Banjo, Mandolin, Lute, and Ukulele.
- Achieved a 2nd degree black belt in Taekwondo and a 1st degree black belt in Krav Maga.
 - Taught Taekwondo for three years to students of all ages before starting university.
- Enjoy playing video games, board games, and chess in my free time.